

Coursework Mark Scheme

The marking is divided into 5 categories. Three of them are weighted at 35% and the other two at 15%. The next page provides a detailed breakdown of the marking rubric.

After marking, you will have access to an online commented version of your essay in your Virtual Campus account.

Context & command of the subject (35%)

This category marks whether the essay's landmark paper has been explained, discussed and its choice has been justified. It also marks the original component associated to the essay (simulation, literature review, etc); the quality of the associated description of this component and its the added value to providing context of the landmark paper.

Is the historical context provided clearly and concisely? Is the content of the landmark paper discussed well in the essay?

Is the original component explained sufficiently to be reproduced by others? Is the original component directly linked to the landmark paper and does it complement its content?

Argumentation & Language (35%)

This category marks whether the essay is written transparently and in correct English. The sentences should be clear and concise, punctuated accordingly. Each paragraph is expected to contain a single major, distinct concept. Marks will be awarded here for appropriate choices of issues to discuss and the clarity of the exposition.

Are arguments provided scientific, clear, concise and backed-up by literature? Are opinions provided substantiated by evidence beyond personal opinions? Is the report written in good English with no spelling, punctuation or grammatical errors? Is the language professional and appropriate for a short research paper?

Is the length of the paper appropriate and are the different sections (if any) of relevance? Cohesiveness and general structure are also marked here.

Typos, misspellings, comma-spliced or long and convoluted sentences are all negative factors here. Speculative sentences, unstructured paragraphs and lengthy texts are negative factors in this section.

Format (15%)

This category marks whether the report is formatted adequately. You should follow standard scientific notation throughout, with equations written in standard scientific terms and flowing with the text. The quality, usefulness and context of the provided figures will be marked here.

Are figures and tables presented clearly, with associated captions describing them appropriately? Is the page limit adhered to? Are equations, figures, tables (if any) presented clearly and within standards of the discipline?

Floating tables/figures are negative factors here, as are undefined variables in equations.

Referencing (15%)

This category marks the bibliography, but also whether literature has been used to support or inform your discussion.

Are the references correctly formatted using a standard scientific referencing style (such as given in the referencing guide on the [university library website](#))? Is the number of sources appropriate and are they drawn from a variety of academic, solid references? Are the sources dominated by refereed publications rather than non-refereed (wiki, internet) secondary sources?

	Command of the subject	Argumentation and language	Format	Referencing
90-100	Demonstrates a breadth and depth of substantive knowledge that is exceptional and informed by the highest level of scholarship. Goes beyond the material displaying exceptional flair in tackling issues identified. Being original within the discipline on the basis of its excellence .	Achieving the highest level of compelling, coherent and concise argument attainable within the level of study. Flawless write-up , without any spelling or grammar mistakes.	Exceptional professional presentation reflecting professional norms.	Using a full range of high-quality sources to inform but not dominate the argument.
80-89	Demonstrates a breadth and depth of substantive knowledge that is comprehensive , accurate, relevant and informed by advanced scholarship. Goes beyond the material with excellent conceptualization which is original, innovative and/or insightful.	Compelling, coherent and concise argument . Exceptional write-up , with minimal spelling or grammar issues throughout.	Excellent professional presentation reflecting professional norms.	Drawing on a full range of high-quality sources.
70-79	Informed by a breadth and depth of substantive knowledge that is comprehensive , accurate, relevant with an awareness of advanced scholarship. Goes beyond the material with very good conceptualization which is often original, innovative and/or insightful.	Arguments which are coherent, concise and frequently compelling. Excellent write-up , with less than 2 spelling or grammar mistakes.	Very good professional presentation reflecting professional norms.	Drawing on a wide range of high-quality sources.
60-69	Demonstrates a breadth and depth of substantive knowledge that is comprehensive and accurate . Some good insight into the material.	Arguments which are coherent and concise and offer robust conclusions . Very good write-up , with 2 to 3 spelling or grammar mistakes.	Professional presentation reflecting professional norms.	Clear differentiation between the quality and appropriateness of sources used.
50-59	Demonstrates an adequate breadth and depth of substantive knowledge but with only a few errors or omissions. Shows some ability to critically engage with the material.	The repetition of, rather than critical engagement with, limited sources. Drawing adequate conclusions which do not always fully reflect the complexity of the subject matter. Good write-up , with up to 5 spelling or grammar mistakes.	Presentation which adequately reflects relevant professional norms.	Adequate differentiation between the quality and appropriateness of sources use.
40-49	Incomplete breadth and depth of substantive knowledge with some errors or omissions. Limited and underdeveloped critical engagement with the material.	A limited and underdeveloped structure of argument. Work that is of limited coherence and clarity. Regular write-up , spelling and grammar are an issue.	Presentation which reflects professional practice in a limited manner .	Limited attention paid to the quality, range and appropriateness of sources used.

30-39	Little relevant knowledge, which is minimal in its breadth and depth with major errors or omissions. Fails to demonstrate sufficient critical engagement with the material.	Poorly informed work with a minimal evidence base. No real underlying structure of arguments. Work that is frequently confused and incoherent. Poor write-up, spelling and grammar hamper readability.	Presentation which displays little more than cursory attention to professional norms.	Minimal attention paid to the quality, range and appropriateness of sources used.
20-29	Does not demonstrate even a basic understanding of the subject matter. Little evidence of critical engagement with the material.	Poorly informed opinion-led work rather than evidence based argument. No real underlying structure of argument. Very poor write-up, document is difficult to understand.	No attention to the disciplinary norms of presentation.	A lack of attention to the quality, range and appropriateness of sources used.
10-19	Demonstrates confusion over the subject matter. No evidence of critical engagement with the material. Work that completely misrepresents or misunderstands thinking in the discipline.	Unsubstantiated assertion with no evidence base. Failure to structure the argument being presented. Write-up conveys little meaning.	No real attention to the disciplinary norms of presentation.	Inadequacy of sources used.
0-9	Demonstrates mainly ignorance of the subject matter by presenting information of minimal relevance.	Work that is confused and incoherent. Write-up conveys no meaning.	No real attention to any norms of presentation.	Absence or misuse of sources.